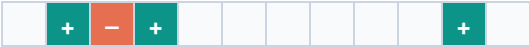


9-11 · Reuse vs recombination: clone a working block; recombine when you need a new part

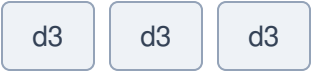
the two-operation task (needs both):



fine motif (+ − +), adjacent
needs dilation 1

far spike, distance s
needs reach (dilation 3)

reuse: identical blocks



✗ blind to fine motif (0/8)

recombine: different blocks



✓ fine + reach (8/8)

the same trade-off in nature

clone → scale

runners, rhizomes, mycelium:
repeat a working module, no search

recombine → new part

sexual reproduction: expensive
search, only when more-of-the-same
will not do

A staged searcher (Sec. 11) clones by default and recombines only when cloning stalls — and beats both fixed strategies.